

# Occam's Razor

## What is it?

The simplest explanation or solution — with the fewest assumptions — is usually the best.

## History

Originates from the philosophy of William of Ockham around **1320**, emphasizing that unnecessary complexity should be avoided when simpler reasoning provides the same result.

## The Psychology Behind It

- The brain prefers simplicity over complexity
- Too many options increase cognitive load
- Simpler solutions reduce friction and confusion
- Clear direct design supports faster decision making

## Why It Matters

- Enhances clarity and usability
- Reduces mental effort
- Risk of oversimplifying important nuance
- Simplicity varies by audience and context

## How to Apply It

- Simplify flows (clear menus, simple checkout, minimal pop-ups)
- Remove visual clutter and distractions
- Prioritize what matters and trim the noise
- Balance minimalism with necessary complexity
- Use context to decide where simplicity is beneficial

## Theory in Action

- Google's homepage uses one clean search field with minimal UI distractions
- IKEA furniture relies on simple functional design that is easy to understand

## Final Thought

Simplicity isn't just aesthetic — it leads to better decisions and better experience. The best design delivers clarity while removing everything that does not matter.

